

Lecture 2: DNN Basics (Continued)

CS 580B1: Trustworthy Machine Learning

Fall 2024

Acknowledgments

Course slides derived from material created by Rajeev Alur and Osbert Bastani at UPenn ([link](#) to their course)

Other relevant courses:

[CS 329T](#) at Stanford

[CS 521](#) at UIUC

[ECE1784H/CSC2559H](#) at U Toronto

Course logistics

- Now recording on Echo 360
- Form teams by Aug 23, 11:59 PM
- Final project can also be done as a group (2-3 members)

Agenda

- DNN Basics
 - DNN Computational Model
 - DNN Training
 - Backpropagation
- PyTorch Basics

DNN Basics

- A simple feedforward neural network with 1 hidden layer:

$$f_{\theta}(x) := W^{(2)} \left(g(W^{(1)}x + b^{(1)}) \right) + b^{(2)}$$

where

- $f_{\theta}: \mathbb{R}^i \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^o$,
- $W^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{k \times i}$, $b^{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^k$, $W^{(2)} \in \mathbb{R}^{o \times k}$, $b^{(2)} \in \mathbb{R}^o$ are parameters (or weights) to be learnt and k is the **number of hidden neurons**,
- $x \in \mathbb{R}^i$ is an input,
- $g: \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is an **activation function** applied component-wise, i.e.,
$$g \left(\begin{bmatrix} z_1 \\ z_2 \end{bmatrix} \right) = \begin{bmatrix} g(z_1) \\ g(z_2) \end{bmatrix}$$

Feedforward neural network with 1 hidden layer

$$f_{\theta}(x) := x$$

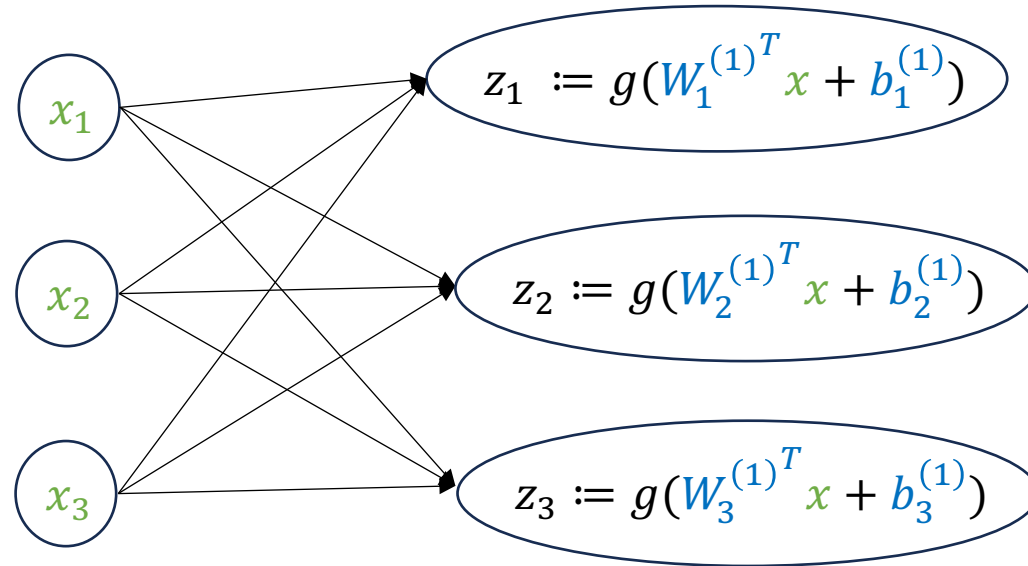
$$x_1$$

$$x_2$$

$$x_3$$

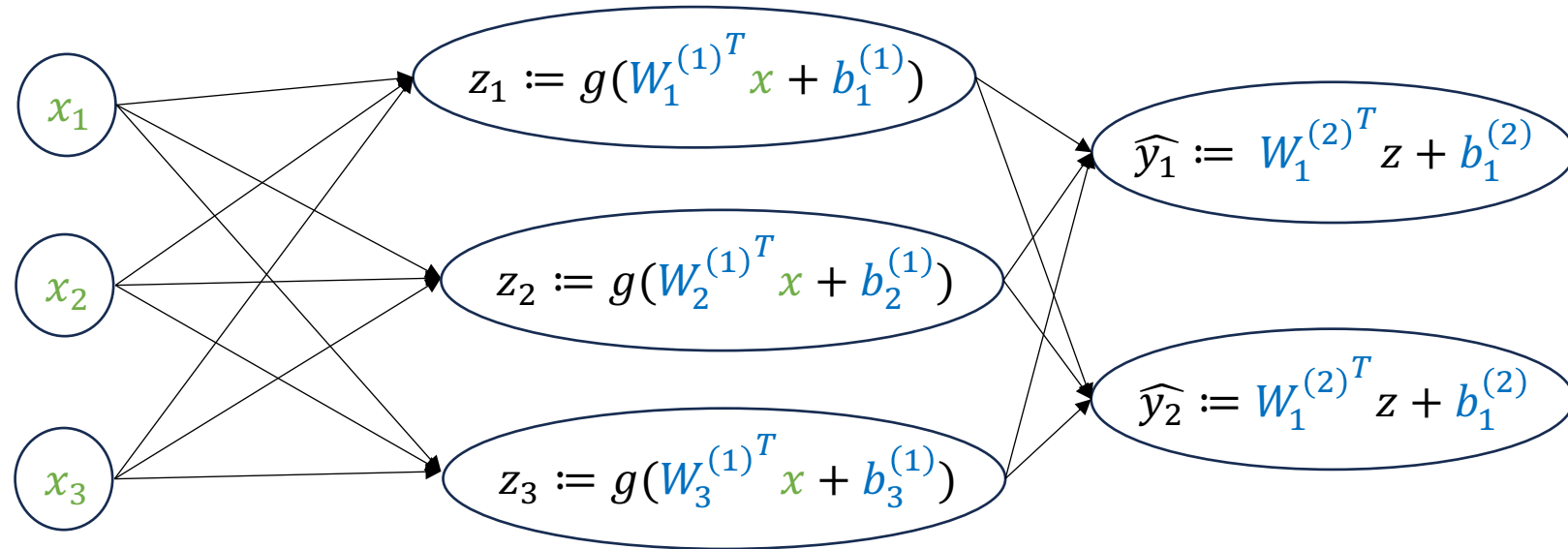
Feedforward neural network with 1 hidden layer

$$f_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}) := g(\mathbf{W}^{(1)}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{b}^{(1)})$$



Feedforward neural network with 1 hidden layer

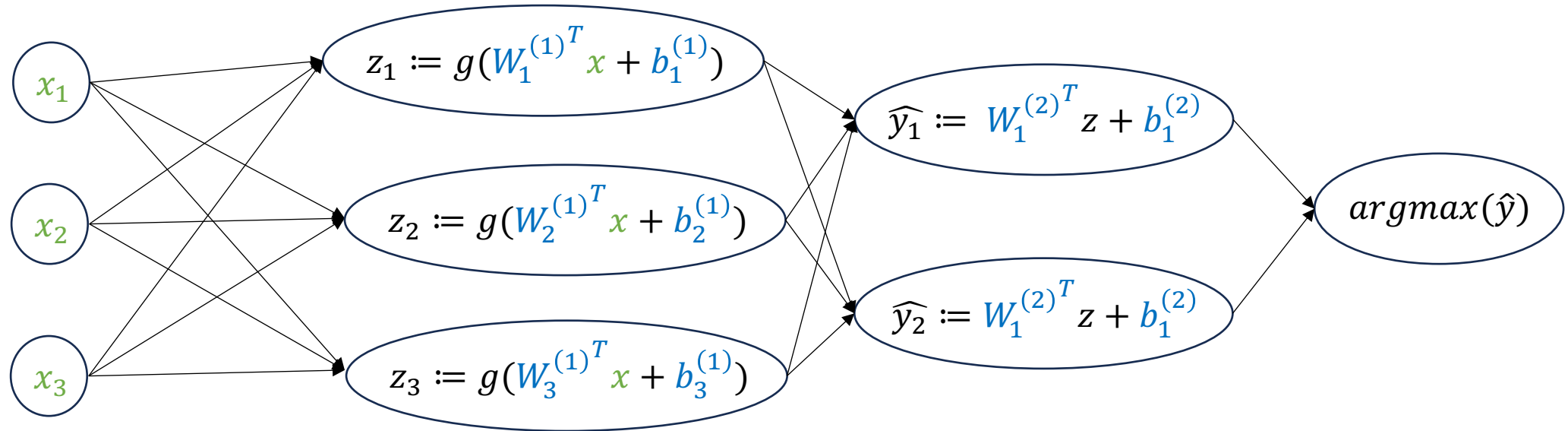
$$f_{\theta}(x) := W^{(2)} \left(g(W^{(1)}x + b^{(1)}) \right) + b^{(2)}$$



where $i = 3, o = 2, k = 3$

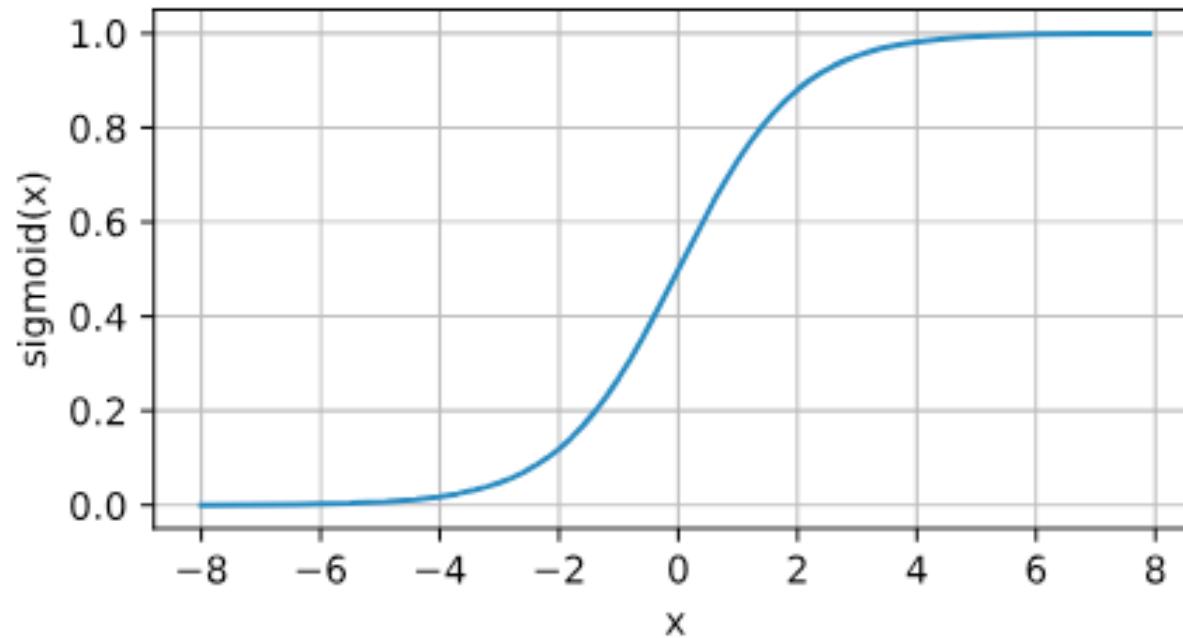
What about classification?

$$F_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}) := \operatorname{argmax}(f_{\theta}(\mathbf{x})) = \operatorname{argmax}(\mathbf{W}^{(2)} \left(g(\mathbf{W}^{(1)} \mathbf{x} + \mathbf{b}^{(1)}) \right) + \mathbf{b}^{(2)})$$



Activation functions

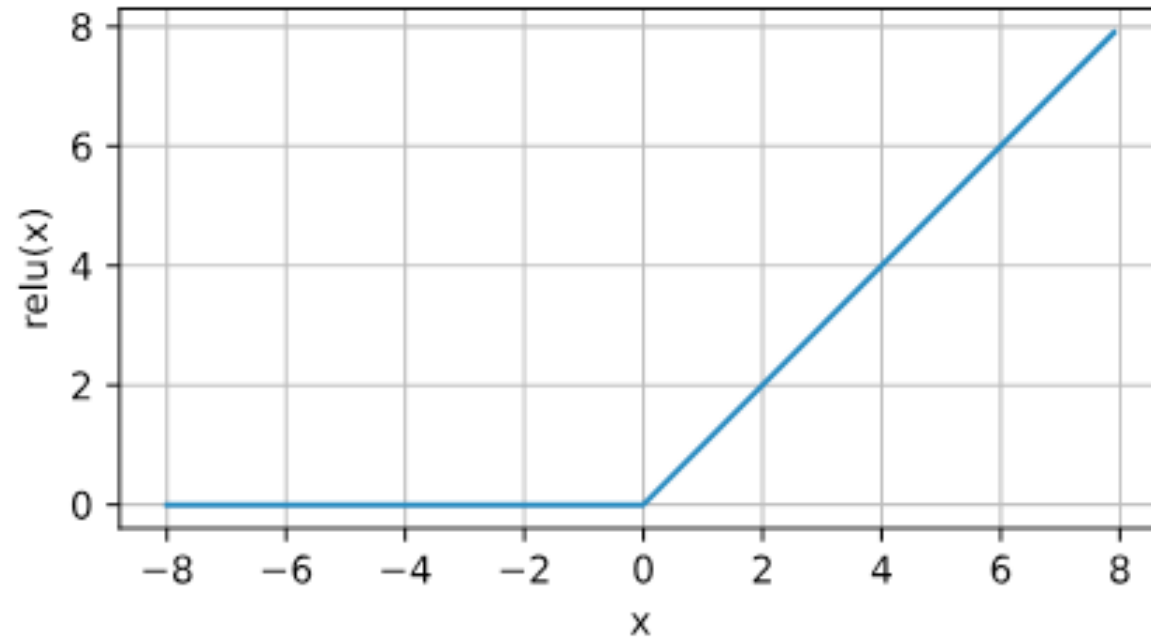
$$g(z) := \sigma(z) := \frac{1}{1 + e^{-z}}$$



https://d2l.ai/chapter_multilayer-perceptrons/mlp.html

Activation functions

$$g(z) := \text{ReLU}(z) := \max(0, z)$$



https://d2l.ai/chapter_multilayer-perceptrons/mlp.html

Deep neural networks, generally

- “**Layers**” are building blocks
- Each layer is a parametric/non-parametric non-linear/linear function
 $f_{\theta(i)}: \mathbb{R}^{d'} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{d''}$
- Combine layers to form a model “**architecture**”, for instance, sequential composition of affine (i.e., $Wz + b$) and activation layers to form a feed-forward DNN

$$f_{\theta} := f_{\theta(m)}(\dots(f_{\theta(1)})\dots) = f_{\theta(m)} \circ \dots \circ f_{\theta(1)}$$

- Each layer is comprised of neurons/nodes/units

The deep learning recipe

- Collect large amounts of data, for instance, (x_i, y_i) pairs for supervised learning
- Design neural network architecture guided by “implicit” **structure/symmetries** in data (for instance, images are translation invariant, sentence should be read forwards)
- Learn model parameters by framing the learning problem as an optimization problem

Learning as optimization

Learning objective: Given model f_θ , find a valuation for parameters θ such that the **training loss** is minimized.

Training loss: For a training dataset with n samples (i.e., n pairs of (x_i, y_i)) and a model f_θ , the training loss is given by

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n L(f_{\theta_0}(x_i), y_i)$$

where $L(\hat{y}_i, y_i)$ is a function that compares the output of the DNN on an input x_i with the ground-truth y_i .

- L can take many forms such as $(\hat{y}_i - y_i)^2$, $\mathbb{1}_{\hat{y}_i=y_i}$, ...

Learning as optimization

Learning objective: Given model f_θ , find a valuation for parameters θ such that the **training loss** is minimized.

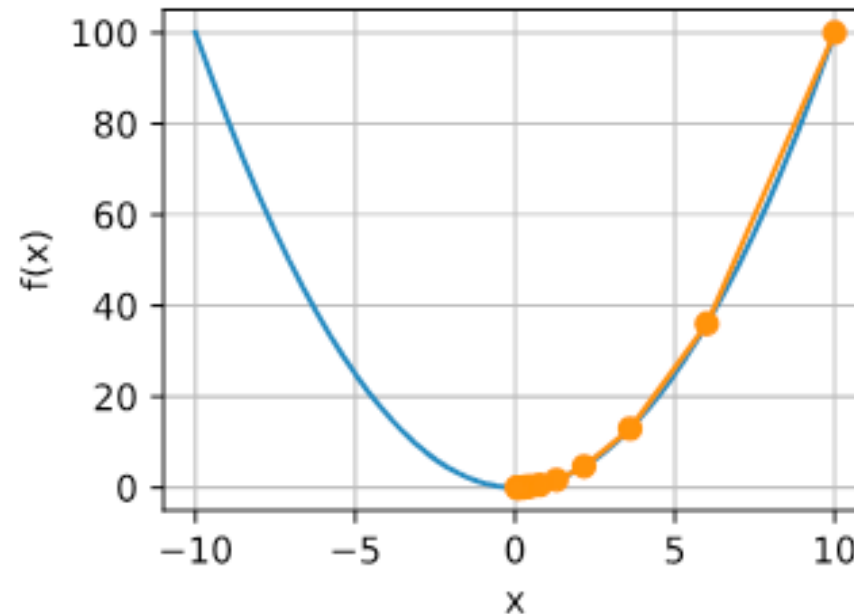
$$\operatorname{argmin}_\theta \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n L(f_\theta(x_i), y_i)$$

How to solve the optimization problem?

Gradient Descent!

Gradient descent algorithm

- Iterative algorithm to find the minimum of a function
- In each step, move in the direction opposite to the gradient
- Guaranteed to converge to the global minimum for **convex, differentiable** functions



Gradient descent for DNN training

```
 $\theta_0 \leftarrow \text{Initialize}()$   
 $t \leftarrow 0$   
Until convergence:  
     $\theta_{t+1}^{(j)} \leftarrow \theta_t^{(j)} - \eta \nabla_{\theta^{(j)}} \left( \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n L(f_{\theta_t}(x_i), y_i) \right)$  (for each  $j$ )  
     $t \leftarrow t + 1$   
return  $f_{\theta_t}$ 
```

DNN training objectives are highly non-convex. Algorithm not guaranteed to converge!!

In practice, many small modifications to this algorithm to make it effective:

- Use stochastic gradient descent (SGD)
 - How to initialize parameters?
 - How to choose learning rate η ? How to adapt it during training?
 - Use of regularization such as weight decay
 - Use of momentum
-
- See Chapter 12 of [Dive into Deep Learning](#) book and Chapter 8 of the [Deep Learning](#) book for more on DNN training algorithms

The deep learning recipe

- Collect large amounts of data, for instance, (x_i, y_i) pairs for supervised learning
- Design neural network architecture guided by “implicit” **structure/symmetries** in data (for instance, images are translation invariant, sentence should be read forwards)
- Learn model parameters via gradient descent
- Modern frameworks such as PyTorch, JAX, and TensorFlow make it very easy to define new architectures + come with in-built **generic** implementations of gradient descent

How to calculate the gradients?

Backpropagation!

Review of differentiation

Scalar functions

$$f: \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$
$$\frac{df}{dx}: \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

Functions from vectors to scalars

$$f: \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$
$$(\text{gradient}) \frac{df}{dx}: \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{1 \times m} = \nabla f := \left[\frac{\partial f}{\partial x_1}, \dots, \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_m} \right]$$

Review of Differentiation

Functions from vectors to vectors

$$f: \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$$

$$(\text{Jacobian}) \frac{df}{dx}: \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{n \times m} = Jf = \nabla f :=$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial x_1} & \cdots & \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial x_m} \\ \vdots & & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial f_n}{\partial x_1} & \cdots & \frac{\partial f_n}{\partial x_m} \end{bmatrix}$$

Backpropagation

$$F(x) := L \left(\overbrace{f^{(2)} \left(f^{(1)}(x) \right)}^f \right)$$

$$F : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

$$f^{(1)} : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{d'}$$

$$f^{(2)} : \mathbb{R}^{d'} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{d''}$$

$$L : \mathbb{R}^{d''} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

$$y = F(x)$$

$$z^{(1)} = f^{(1)}(x)$$

$$z^{(2)} = f^{(2)}(z^{(1)})$$

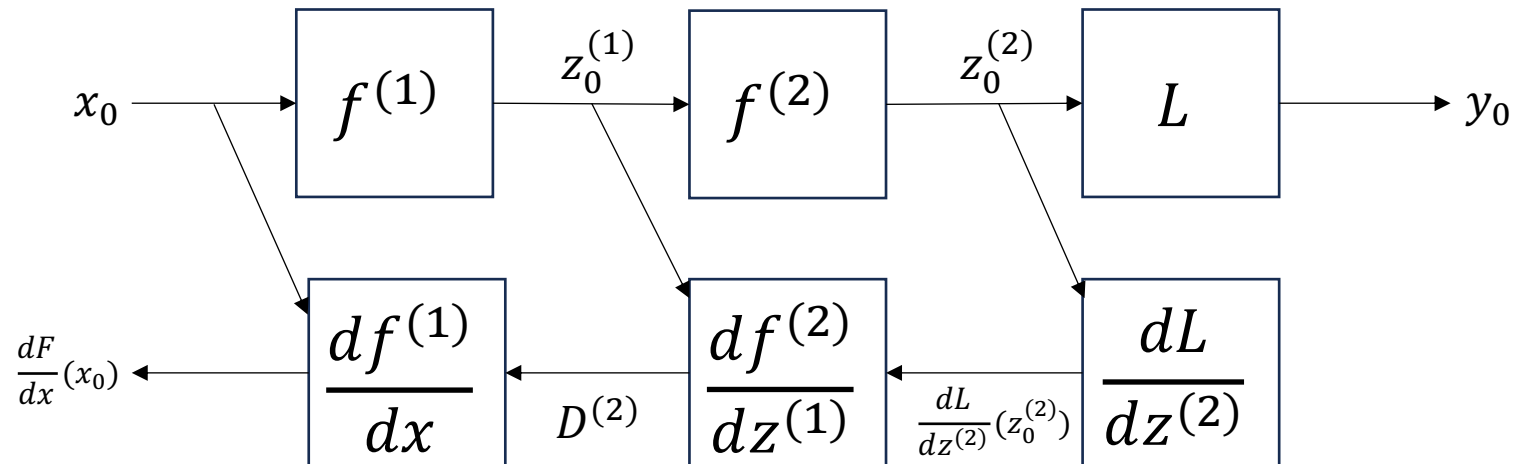
$$y = L(z^{(2)})$$

$$\frac{dF}{dx} : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{1 \times d} = \frac{dL}{dz^{(2)}} \frac{df^{(2)}}{dz^{(1)}} \frac{df^{(1)}}{dx} \quad (\text{chain rule})$$

Backpropagation

How to calculate $\frac{dF}{dx}$ at a specific input x_0 ?

$$\frac{dF}{dx}(x_0) = \underbrace{\left(\left(\frac{dL}{dz^{(2)}}(z_0^{(2)}) \frac{df^{(2)}}{dz^{(1)}}(z_0^{(1)}) \right) \right)}_{D^{(2)}} \frac{df^{(1)}}{dx}(x_0)$$



Backpropagation for neural networks

$$F_{\theta}(x) = L \left(\overbrace{f_{\theta(2)} \left(f_{\theta(1)}(x) \right)}^{f_{\theta}} \right)$$

$$\begin{aligned} F_{\theta} &: \mathbb{R}^d \times \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \\ f_{\theta(1)} &: \mathbb{R}^d \times \mathbb{R}^{n'} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{d'} \\ f_{\theta(2)} &: \mathbb{R}^{d'} \times \mathbb{R}^{n''} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{d''} \\ L &: \mathbb{R}^{d''} \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} y &= F_{\theta}(x) \\ z^{(1)} &= f_{\theta(1)}(x) \\ z^{(2)} &= f_{\theta(2)}(z^{(1)}) \\ y &= L(z^{(2)}) \end{aligned}$$

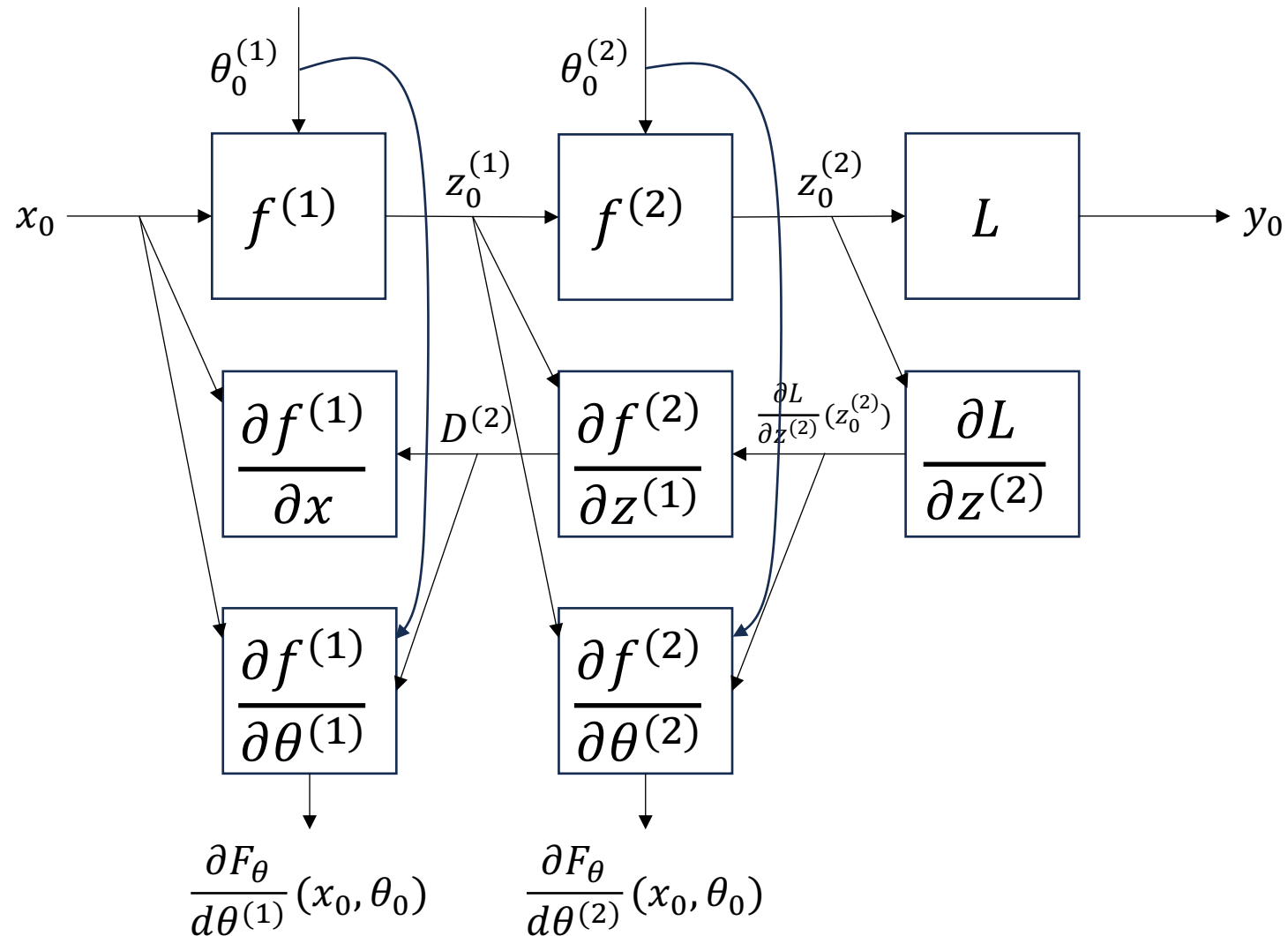
We need to compute $\frac{\partial F_{\theta}}{\partial \theta^{(1)}}$ and $\frac{\partial F_{\theta}}{\partial \theta^{(2)}}$ at specific inputs x_0 and θ_0

Backpropagation for neural networks

$$\frac{\partial F_{\theta}}{\partial \theta^{(1)}}(x_0, \theta_0) = \left(\underbrace{\left(\frac{\partial L}{\partial z^{(2)}}(z_0^{(2)}) \frac{\partial f^{(2)}}{\partial z^{(1)}}(z_0^{(1)}, \theta_0^{(2)}) \right)}_{D^{(2)}} \frac{\partial f^{(1)}}{\partial \theta^{(1)}}(x_0, \theta_0) \right)$$

$$\frac{\partial F_{\theta}}{\partial \theta^{(2)}}(x_0, \theta_0) = \left(\frac{\partial L}{\partial z^{(2)}}(z_0^{(2)}) \frac{\partial f^{(2)}}{\partial \theta^{(2)}}(z_0^{(1)}, \theta_0^{(2)}) \right)$$

Backpropagation for neural networks



Automatic Differentiation

- General version of Backpropagation Algorithm
- Two variants: reverse mode and forward mode
- Automatically calculate derivatives of computer programs
- See *Baydin et al., Automatic Differentiation in Machine Learning: a Survey, JMLR'18* for more

More resources

Chapter 2.5 of Dougal MacLaurin's [thesis](#)

Chapter 5 of book "[Mathematics for Machine Learning](#)"

DNN Frameworks

- Various frameworks such as PyTorch, TensorFlow, JAX have helped democratize deep learning
- Come with implementation of backpropagation, different variants of gradient descent, and various common layers
 - Only need gradients for new layers
- DNN architectures as a composition of layers
 - Represented as a graph to allow general compositions

PyTorch Basics

```
1  import argparse
2  import torch
3  import torch.nn as nn
4  import torch.nn.functional as F
5  import torch.optim as optim
6  from torchvision import datasets, transforms
7  from torch.optim.lr_scheduler import StepLR
8
```

Common parent class: nn.Module

```
10  class Net(nn.Module):
11      def __init__(self):
12          super(Net, self).__init__()
13          self.conv1 = nn.Conv2d(1, 32, 3, 1)
14          self.conv2 = nn.Conv2d(32, 64, 3, 1)
15          self.dropout1 = nn.Dropout(0.25)
16          self.dropout2 = nn.Dropout(0.5)
17          self.fc1 = nn.Linear(9216, 128)
18          self.fc2 = nn.Linear(128, 10)
19
```

Constructor: Defining layers of the DNN

PyTorch Basics

Forward propagation

```
20 def forward(self, x):
21     x = self.conv1(x)
22     x = F.relu(x)
23     x = self.conv2(x)
24     x = F.relu(x)
25     x = F.max_pool2d(x, 2)
26     x = self.dropout1(x)
27     x = torch.flatten(x, 1)
28     x = self.fc1(x)
29     x = F.relu(x)
30     x = self.dropout2(x)
31     x = self.fc2(x)
32     output = F.log_softmax(x, dim=1)
33     return output
34
35
```

PyTorch Basics

```
36  def train(args, model, device, train_loader, optimizer, epoch):
    model.train()
38      for batch_idx, (data, target) in enumerate(train_loader):
39          data, target = data.to(device), target.to(device)
40          optimizer.zero_grad()
41          output = model(data)
42          loss = F.nll_loss(output, target)
43          loss.backward()
44          optimizer.step()
45          if batch_idx % args.log_interval == 0:
46              print('Train Epoch: {} [{}/{}] ({:.0f}%) \t Loss: {:.6f}'.format(
47                  epoch, batch_idx * len(data), len(train_loader.dataset),
48                  100. * batch_idx / len(train_loader), loss.item()))
49          if args.dry_run:
50              break
51
```

Looping over minibatches of data

Run forward pass

Loss computation

Update parameters using gradients

Zero out old gradients

Backpropagation